

Philipp Hilbert. *Proxy Product Owner, Retail Banking Group.*

Positioning, Thirteen years translating complex regulated-domain requirements into shipped digital products, ready to do the same for Mashreq's retail banking journeys.

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§ WHY MASHREQ

Mashreq's Retail Banking Group is building digital-first customer journeys at the intersection of compliance-heavy regulation and consumer expectations that are genuinely shifting, not just a technology refresh, but a structural re-design of how a bank engages retail clients end to end. The Injaz programme, specifically, signals a commitment to outcome-based squad delivery rather than waterfall project management dressed in Agile language, which is precisely the environment where embedded Proxy Product Owners add the most leverage. The posting calls for someone who can navigate business, engineering, QA, Governance, and Compliance simultaneously, that exact stakeholder matrix is where the last decade of my career has played out. *That is exactly the combination where I do my best work.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case coverage
- **GitHub Copilot**, development acceleration within squads
- **Cursor**, context-aware refactoring and code review
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for stakeholder demos
- **Framer**, design-heavy journey wireframing
- **GPT**, requirements drafting and acceptance-criteria review

- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
 - **Gamma.app**, executive-ready roadmap presentations
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, Git, GitLab, Jenkins, ArgoCD, Kubernetes, Docker, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Dagster, dbt, Kafka, Shopware, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MASHREQ

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the squad ceremonies, read the existing backlog and acceptance criteria in Azure DevOps, and map where sprint commitments are slipping against the retail banking product roadmap, producing a one-page gap summary for the Product Owner before week two begins.

WEEK 2

Refine and prioritise.

Run the first backlog refinement I own: rewrite the top-priority user stories to the squad's definition of done, surface missing acceptance criteria, and flag dependency risks to QA and Compliance before they become blockers.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Drive sprint ceremonies end to end, planning, daily, review, retrospective, and track committed items to completion, turning release readiness into a repeatable check rather than a late-sprint scramble.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Digital Product Expert / Proxy Product Owner role within Mashreq's Retail Banking Group. With thirteen years of product ownership across regulated industries, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, fintech, and secure government data, I have spent most of my career doing precisely what this role describes: sitting between business stakeholders and engineering squads, turning ambiguous requirements into working software, and keeping teams honest about sprint commitments.

The specific challenge in retail banking is that the compliance and governance surface is wide, the customer journey complexity is high, and delivery discipline has to hold across all of it simultaneously. I have operated in structurally similar environments. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, leading a cross-functional team of fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence, a programme where governance failure is not an option. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I held the additional role of Deputy IT Security Officer while managing a national analytics platform, which meant keeping engineering velocity up while satisfying audit and security requirements that could not be deferred. At AOK ITSCare I built and prioritised the backlog for a B2B procurement webshop on Shopware, writing user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira and carrying the migration through to production for roughly 20,000 end users, still running today.

What I bring specifically to a Proxy Product Owner role is the ability to hold two things at once that often come apart in practice: rigorous requirements definition and genuine technical depth. I can write a user story that a developer can implement without a follow-up conversation, and I can sit in a sprint planning session in Azure DevOps and challenge an estimate or a technical approach from a position of understanding rather than authority. I have used Azure DevOps as a delivery tool on multiple programmes, and I know the difference between a backlog that looks healthy and one that actually is.

On the AI-native side: I build internal tooling with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Cursor, and I use LLM-assisted spec generation to accelerate acceptance-criteria coverage on complex journeys, an approach that meaningfully reduces the rework loop between business requirements and implementation-ready stories.

I am an EU citizen based in Berlin, actively targeting Dubai and the UAE, and willing to relocate fully on-site. I am available at short notice.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of ownership in regulated industries: defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, payments, and retail banking-adjacent domains. I translate product strategy and business requirements into prioritised backlogs, well-formed user stories, and shipped sprints, working across business stakeholders, engineering, QA, Governance, and Compliance as a single point of accountability for squad execution.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Agile Delivery (SDLC): Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, sprint planning, backlog refinement, retrospectives, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence

Requirements Engineering: user stories, acceptance criteria, functional specifications, use cases, workflows, definition of done, epics, UAT (user acceptance testing)

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership (engineering, QA, data science, compliance, UX), C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists; GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout from days to 30 minutes; pipeline runs increased 200% by redirecting strategy to developer-code-first workflows; Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market analytics platform; Deputy IT Security Officer; introduced Dagster and dbt, saving ~75% of time per data update; migrated bare-metal system to containers; Jenkins pipeline with integrated test automation.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold; implemented CGM interface into KIS workflows, reducing anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to one departure; shipped Claims Center concept to production; cut new-product time-to-market from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

POS and forecourt systems; moved research to production in a SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT SECURE DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B WEBSHOP 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production; user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY SITE IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK
2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one B2B two-sided marketplace; LLM agents across the funnel; WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface; funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Enterprise hardware-software product for quantum-resistant encryption; shipped three-layer install in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY AND AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments; built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

LinkedIn · GitHub · www.true-north.berlin · YouTube (EN sample)
